Chess Enrichment Program

8-Week Curriculum Guide

Think. Play. Grow.

Beginner Level

Foundation Skills: Learning piece movements, basic rules, and fundamental game concepts

Week 1: Introduction to Chess & The Board

Component	Description
Learning Goals	• Understand the chessboard setup (files, ranks, squares) • Learn piece names and initial positions • Grasp the basic objective of the game
Activities	• Board scavenger hunt (finding specific squares) • Piece placement race • Chess piece memory game
Superpower	Focus - Paying attention to details on the board

Week 2: Pawn Power & Basic Movement

Component	Description
Learning Goals	• Master pawn movement (forward, capture diagonally) • Understand the concept of capturing • Learn basic pawn strategy (advancing, protecting)
Activities	• Pawn races (first to reach opposite side) • Capture challenges with pawns only • Pawn chain building exercises
Superpower	Patience - Taking time to think before moving

Week 3: Knights & Their Jumps

Component	Description
Learning Goals	• Learn the L-shaped knight movement pattern • Understand knight's ability to jump over pieces • Practice knight positioning and control

Component	Description
Activities	• Knight tour challenges (visiting all squares) • Knight vs. pawns mini-games • Finding all possible knight moves puzzles
Superpower	Creativity - Thinking in unique patterns

Week 4: Bishops & Rooks - The Sliding Pieces

Component	Description
Learning Goals	• Master bishop movement (diagonal sliding) • Master rook movement (horizontal/vertical sliding) • Understand how pieces can block each other
Activities	• Bishop maze navigation • Rook capture challenges • Bishop vs. rook mini-games
Superpower	Strategic Thinking - Planning moves ahead

Week 5: The Queen - The Most Powerful Piece

Component	Description
Learning Goals	• Learn queen's combined movement (bishop + rook) • Understand queen's power and value • Practice protecting the queen
Activities	• Queen vs. multiple pieces challenges • Finding the safest queen moves • Queen rescue missions
Superpower	Confidence - Making bold but careful moves

Week 6: The King & Check

Component	Description
Learning Goals	• Master king movement (one square in any direction) • Understand the concept of check • Learn three ways to get out of check
Activities	• Check identification exercises • Escaping check puzzles • King safety drills

Component	Description
Superpower	Awareness - Always protecting what's most important

Week 7: Checkmate Patterns

Component	Description
Learning Goals	• Learn basic checkmate patterns (back rank, queen + king) • Practice delivering checkmate • Recognize checkmate vs. stalemate
Activities	• One-move checkmate puzzles • Checkmate races • Stalemate avoidance practice
Superpower	Determination - Working toward your goal

Week 8: Playing Complete Games & Review

Component	Description
Learning Goals	• Play complete games with all rules • Practice good sportsmanship • Review all pieces and movements
Activities	• Mini-tournament (15-minute games) • Piece value review games • Certificate ceremony and celebration
Superpower	Respect - Being gracious in victory and defeat

Intermediate Level

Building on fundamentals: Developing tactical awareness, opening principles, and strategic thinking

Week 1: Special Moves & Advanced Rules

Component	Description
Learning Goals	• Master castling (kingside and queenside) • Learn en passant capture • Understand pawn promotion
Activities	• Castling timing exercises • En passant recognition drills • Pawn promotion races
Superpower	Adaptability - Learning new techniques

Week 2: Opening Principles

Component	Description
Learning Goals	• Control the center of the board • Develop pieces quickly and efficiently • Castle early for king safety
Activities	• Good vs. bad opening comparison games • Speed development challenges • Opening principles puzzles
Superpower	Planning - Thinking several moves ahead

Week 3: Tactical Patterns - Forks

Component	Description
Learning Goals	• Recognize fork opportunities (attacking two pieces) • Execute knight forks effectively • Defend against opponent's forks
Activities	• Fork identification puzzles • Create your own fork positions • Fork defense drills
Superpower	Opportunism - Seizing the moment

Week 4: Tactical Patterns - Pins & Skewers

Component	Description
Learning Goals	• Understand absolute vs. relative pins • Execute skewer tactics • Break pins when possible
Activities	• Pin and skewer puzzle sets • Positions where pins backfire • Tactics combination games
Superpower	Precision - Executing carefully planned tactics

Week 5: Discovered Attacks & Double Checks

Component	Description
Learning Goals	• Recognize discovered attack opportunities • Master double check tactics • Create powerful combinations
Activities	• Discovered attack puzzles • Double check challenges • Multi-move tactical sequences
Superpower	Insight - Seeing hidden possibilities

Week 6: Endgame Fundamentals

Component	Description
Learning Goals	• King and queen vs. king checkmate • King and rook vs. king checkmate • Pawn endgame basics (opposition, key squares)
Activities	• Basic checkmate drills • Pawn endgame exercises • Opposition practice positions
Superpower	Persistence - Never giving up in difficult positions

Week 7: Game Analysis & Strategy

Component	Description
Learning Goals	• Review and analyze own games • Identify mistakes and missed opportunities • Develop a basic opening repertoire

Component	Description
Activities	• Game notation practice • Replay and analyze famous games • Opening exploration sessions
Superpower	Reflection - Learning from experience

Week 8: Tournament Play & Celebration

Component	Description
Learning Goals	• Apply all learned concepts in tournament setting • Practice time management in games • Demonstrate growth and sportsmanship
Activities	• Swiss-system tournament (4 rounds) • Awards ceremony and recognition • Celebration and looking ahead
Superpower	Growth Mindset - Celebrating improvement

Advanced Level

Mastery and competition: Advanced tactics, positional understanding, and competitive preparation

Week 1: Advanced Tactical Combinations

Component	Description
Learning Goals	• Master complex tactical motifs (deflection, decoy, interference) • Execute multi-move combinations • Calculate variations accurately
Activities	• Complex combination puzzles (3-5 move sequences) • Calculation training exercises • Tactical themes deep dive
Superpower	Analytical Thinking - Deep calculation skills

Week 2: Opening Theory & Repertoire Development

Component	Description
Learning Goals	• Study major opening systems (Italian, Spanish, Sicilian) • Build personalized opening repertoire • Understand opening ideas and plans
Activities	• Opening exploration and comparison • Repertoire building workshops • Thematic opening games
Superpower	Knowledge - Building expertise through study

Week 3: Positional Chess & Pawn Structures

Component	Description
Learning Goals	• Analyze pawn structures (chains, islands, weaknesses) • Understand piece coordination and outposts • Evaluate positions strategically
Activities	• Positional evaluation exercises • Pawn structure analysis workshops • Strategic planning games
Superpower	Strategic Vision - Seeing the bigger picture

Week 4: Middlegame Strategy

Component	Description
Learning Goals	• Master attacking techniques and king safety • Understand prophylaxis and move prevention • Create and exploit weaknesses
Activities	• Attack vs. defense scenarios • Prophylactic thinking exercises • Classic middlegame studies
Superpower	Versatility - Adapting to different positions

Week 5: Advanced Endgames

Component	Description
Learning Goals	• Master rook endgames (Lucena, Philidor positions) • Learn bishop vs. knight endgames • Understand passed pawn principles
Activities	• Classical endgame positions • Endgame technique training • Converting advantages exercises
Superpower	Mastery - Executing technique perfectly

Week 6: Tournament Preparation & Psychology

Component	Description
Learning Goals	• Develop pre-game preparation routines • Master time management techniques • Build mental resilience and focus
Activities	• Timed game practice sessions • Mental preparation workshops • Blitz and rapid practice
Superpower	Composure - Staying calm under pressure

Week 7: Game Analysis & Improvement

Component	Description
Learning Goals	• Conduct deep game analysis with annotations • Study GM games and extract lessons

Component	Description
	• Identify personal weaknesses and create improvement plan
Activities	• Annotate own games with variations • Study classic GM games with themes • Create personal training program
Superpower	Self-Awareness - Understanding strengths and weaknesses

Week 8: Championship Tournament

Component	Description
Learning Goals	• Compete at highest level with all skills integrated • Demonstrate competitive excellence • Set goals for continued improvement
Activities	• Full tournament (5-6 rounds, rated games) • Awards ceremony with trophy presentation • Setting future chess goals and celebration
Superpower	Excellence - Striving for mastery